

Structured Data

Data organized into predefined rows and columns, with each column having a defined data type.

Accounting example: The Charles River GLEntry table with columns for PostingDate, AccountID, Debit, Credit, SourceDocumentType, and FiscalPeriod. Each row is one posted ledger entry.

Semi-Structured Data

Data with some organizational elements (tags, labels, hierarchy) but not in a strict row-and-column format.

Accounting example: An XBRL financial filing with tagged data elements organized hierarchically, or a bank statement in PDF format containing embedded transaction tables.

Unstructured Data

Data with no predefined tabular format. Information is stored as free-form text, images, or documents.

Accounting example: The text of a lease agreement, narrative disclosures in an annual report, email correspondence between auditors and clients, or scanned invoice images.



More structure



Less structure

Excel, SQL, and Power BI are designed for structured data. The Charles River dataset is entirely structured.